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12 August 2026

Suncorp Graduate Recruitment Team
Suncorp Group

Re: Application, 2026/27 Technology Vacation Program

Dear Suncorp Graduate Recruitment Team,

I'm writing to express my interest in Suncorp's Technology Vacation Program.

But first, let me tell you a story.

I was basically forced into software engineering.

My parents and my brother thought it was the right degree for me. I did not. But I enrolled anyway, and for most of my first year, I treated university like something I simply had to get through.

I still finished with a Distinction average.

That should have made me happy. Instead, it bothered me.

Because I knew how little I had tried.

There was one Credit on my transcript that frustrated me more than anything else. Not because it was a terrible mark, but because I knew I had earned exactly what I had put in.

Not much.

So when second year began, I decided to change.

At first, I just wanted better marks. Part of me wanted to prove something to the people who had watched me coast through first year.

Then somewhere along the way, something changed.

I started enjoying it.

I stopped asking what I needed to do to finish an assignment and started wondering what else I could make it do.

The clearest example came during one trimester when I had two completely unrelated final projects.

For Backend Development, I was building a REST API for controlling robots. For Embedded Systems, I was building a physical two-wheel robot using an Arduino Nano, Raspberry Pi and several sensors.

They were never supposed to interact.

I decided to connect them.

When I told my backend unit chair, he was supportive, but also honest. It was ambitious. Both projects mattered to my final results, and trying to combine them meant I could end up doing neither properly.

The sensible option was to finish them separately.

I could already see the combined system in my head.

So I took the risk.

For about a month, I built, tested, broke and rebuilt it.

Sometimes the backend worked and the robot ignored it. Sometimes the robot moved while the software thought something completely different had happened. I would solve one problem and realise I had created another somewhere I thought I had already finished.

But I could not leave it alone.

Eventually, the backend spoke to the robot.

And the robot listened.

The backend project received 100 out of 100 and was selected from my cohort to be demonstrated at Deakin Open Day.

I am proud of that result.

But what stays with me is how different I had become.

A year earlier, I was doing the minimum in a degree I had never really wanted to start. Now I was making my own work harder because I cared too much about an idea to leave it unexplored.

Somewhere along the way, software engineering stopped being the degree my family wanted me to do.

It became mine.

That is why I am applying to Suncorp.

I'm not going to pretend insurance was an industry I had always pictured myself working in. It wasn't. But when I looked more closely at Suncorp, I found something that mattered more to me than the industry label: the kind of environment its people described working in.

I read about people being encouraged to bring different perspectives, have their ideas heard and take real ownership of their work. I read Imaan's account of starting as an intern and finding that, rather than simply observing from the sidelines, she was given hands-on experience and felt that her opinions and fresh perspective were valued.

That sounded familiar to me.

I have already had a glimpse of what I am like in that kind of environment, and I love working in it.

When I brought my unit chair an idea that would make two important projects substantially harder, he did not shut it down. He also did not simply tell me it was a great idea and leave it at that. He listened to what I wanted to do, challenged my thinking, made sure I understood the risks and then let me choose my own path.

He gave me room to make the project mine while still pushing me to do more with it.

That combination of trust and challenge brought out something in me that I had not seen during my first year. I became more willing to experiment, more comfortable defending an idea, more open to having that idea questioned and more determined to work through problems I did not yet know how to solve.

That is the kind of environment I want to enter at Suncorp.

I want to find out what happens when this version of me is put into a real technology team. I want to work with people who will listen when I have an idea, challenge it when it needs challenging and trust me to take ownership of what comes next. I want to encounter systems I do not understand yet, get things wrong, ask

questions, defend my thinking when I believe in it and change my mind when someone shows me something better.

Most of all, I want to work on software that matters after I close my laptop, and become a better engineer because the consequences are real rather than another mark on a transcript.

Outside university, I maintain the website for the Boroondara Stroke Support Group and lead LinkedIn for Deakin's Data Science Club. Previously, while serving on the Software Engineering Club committee, I built the application behind a debugging workshop and seeded the bugs attendees had to find. These experiences have started showing me what changes when someone else is actually relying on the work you do.

I started software engineering because other people pushed me into it.

I am still here because I found something that makes me lose track of time.

I am based in Melbourne, available full time from 24 November 2026 to 12 February 2027, and have Australian work rights subject to the conditions of my student visa.

I would like the opportunity to find out where that change in me can take me next, and what I can contribute to Suncorp along the way.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,
Manit Khera